

HENRY TRIGLAR WEEKS, standing at right in front of the Sag Harbor Whaling Museum, was an early proponent of historic preservation efforts in Sag Harbor.

NANCY BOYD WILLEY AND THE OLD SAGG-HARBOUR COMMITTEE

After the brief appearance of the Sag Harbor Historical Society in 1936, interest in historic preservation was revived in the village with the creation of the Old Sagg-Harbour Committee. The organization was formed in 1941 by Nancy Boyd Willey, Henry Triglar Weeks, and a handful of other local residents concerned with the threat of losing historic buildings through neglect or demolition.

Nancy Boyd Willey (1902–1998), a lifelong champion of historic preservation and environmental conservation, descended from a local Sag Harbor family; her grandfather, William Cooper, was a boatbuilder and her mother, Annie Cooper Boyd, a prolific landscape painter who studied at William Merritt Chase's Shinnecock Hills Summer School of Art. Steeped in local history, Willey grew up in Brooklyn and graduated with a degree in sociology from Barnard College in New York City, where she met Malcolm Macdonald Willey (1897–1974).